

You're starting in the field of a DBA just as I did about thirteen years ago.

There is a lot of information out there, you'll hear names dropped, but who are they? You'll hear about tools, and you'll probably be told that you can't do your job without "this tool". And when you become accustomed to all the on-premises solutions, there's the cloud, where everything changes daily.

If you're reading this, you've already taken a crucial step; you're out here learning on your day off. Excellent! Now I'll take you along my journey towards becoming a DBA, both on-premises and on Azure. It's fun, it's hard work, but very rewarding!

I'll show you my favourite tools, books and scripts to give you some structure in advancing your knowledge. I'll show you some techniques I'm using to dive deeper into subjects that interest me and more.



Thank you to our sponsors. Please say hello to them and find out how they can help you.



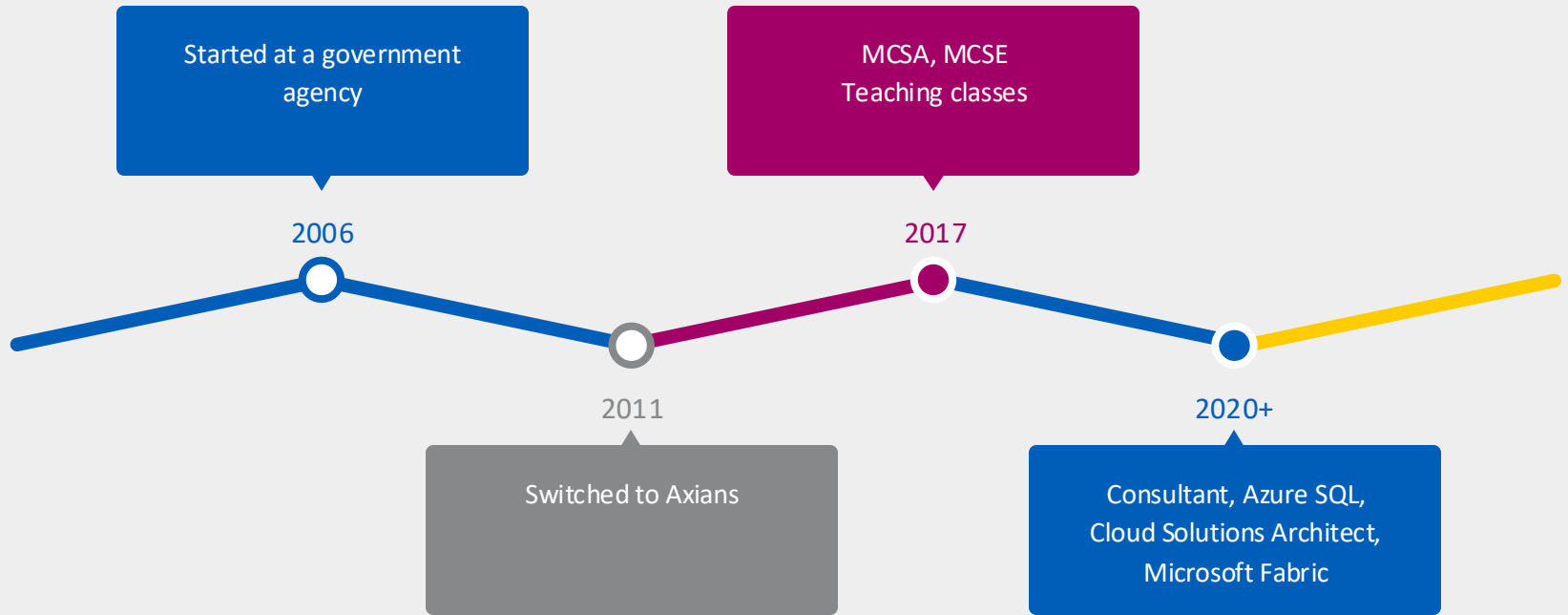
What they should
have told me about
becoming a DBA

Data Céili

13-06-2025



HOW DID I GET UP HERE



Reitse Eskens

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Speaker

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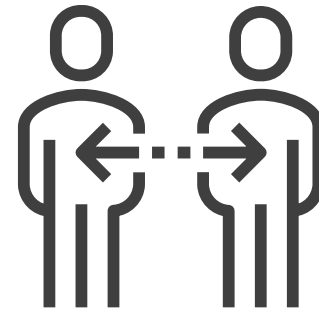


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Talking to people —

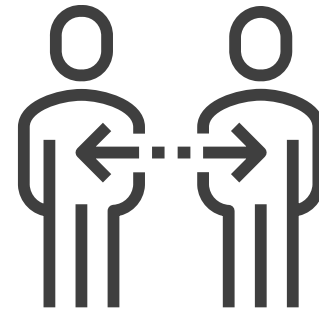
Who should you speak with?

- ▶ DBA's
- ▶ Books
- ▶ Users
- ▶ Peers
- ▶ Management



The essence

- ▶ Correct terminology
- ▶ Asking the right questions



ONE DOES NOT SIMPLY

TALK TO PEOPLE.

Finding information_

- ▶ Itzik Ben-Gan
 - T-SQL Fundamentals 4th edition
 - T-SQL Window functions 2nd edition
 - T-SQL querying

- ▶ Powershell in a month of lunches
- ▶ Dbatools in a month of lunches

- ▶ Query Store for SQL Server 2019: Identify and Fix Poorly Performing Queries



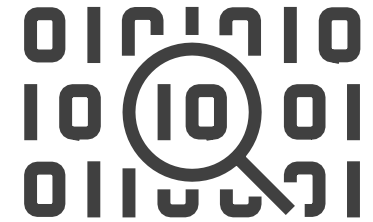
- ▶ Bluesky (#sqlfamily, #sqlhelp)
- ▶ Slack (Sql Server Community)
- ▶ Pinal Dave (sqlauthority.com)
- ▶ Brent Ozar (brentozar.com)
- ▶ SQLSkills (sqlskills.com)
- ▶ Microsoft (learn.Microsoft.com)
- ▶ Blogs ([feedly.com](https://www.feedly.com))



I FIND YOUR LACK OF CYBER SECURITY

DISTURBING

- ▶ Think about roles
- ▶ Know your data
- ▶ Say no and stand firm when you have to





- ▶ No more SQL Server on-premises certifications available
- ▶ [Learn.microsoft.com](https://learn.microsoft.com)
- ▶ MeasureUp!
- ▶ AZ-900 -> DP-900 -> DP-300 -> DP-600 or DP-700



**YOU GET A CERTIFICATE! AND
YOU GET A CERTIFICATE!**

**EVERYBODY GETS A
CERTIFICATE!**

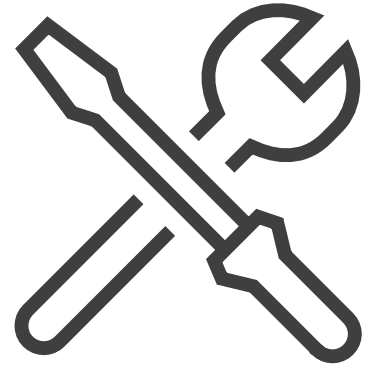


Welcome to Fabric!

Finding the tools_

► Ola Hallengren

- <https://ola.hallengren.com/>
- The solution for maintenance
 - Backups
 - Indexes
 - Statistics
 - Integrity checks



► dbatools

- <https://dbatools.io/>
- Commandlets for repetitive tasks
- Easy to use
- Well documented
- Safe (<https://dbatools.io/secure/>)

► dbachecks

- <https://dbatools.io/introducing-dbachecks/>
- Module for routine checks
- With PowerBI report



► First Responder Kit

- <https://www.brentozar.com/first-aid/>
- Easy scripts to get an overview of the server you're looking at
- Advice on where to focus your attention
- No solution scripts you can easily run, think and edit!
- Free!





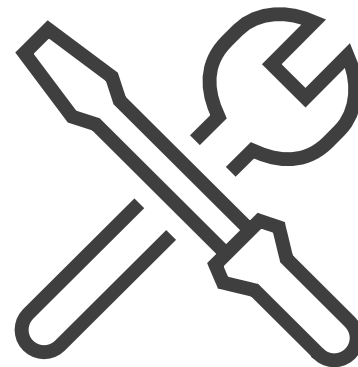
Plan Explorer

- <https://www.sentryone.com/plan-explorer>
- Free tooling for analyzing queries
- Shows animated deadlock diagrams
- Gives you an idea how to add or modify indexes



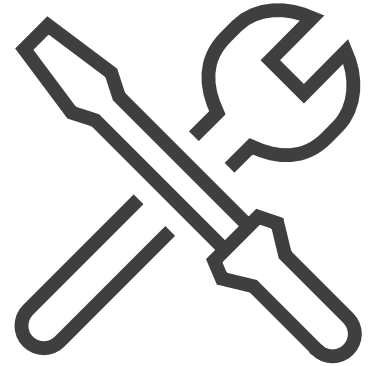
► Execution plan reference

- https://sqlserverfast.com/epr/generic_information/
- Reference for most execution plan icons
- Training on how to analyse queryplans



► VS Code

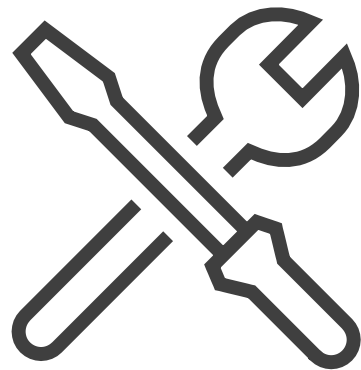
- <https://code.visualstudio.com/>
- Free code editor
- Loads of plugins and integration with git





Windows Terminal

- check out windows store to get it
- Looks like Powershell
- You can choose the version if you have more than one installed
- You can easily connect to Azure to run commands there



CAN SOMEONE HELP ME

MOVE MY TOOLBOX?

Object Explorer

Connect +

sql-planes-preview.database.windows.net (SQL Server 12.0.2000.8)

Databases

Security

SQLQuery1.sql...ail.com (71)

1

Copilot in SSMS

Copilot Preview

Database: NEDERLANDSEGROOTHANDEL

Hi! I'm here to help you with all things SQL.

I'm powered by AI, so surprises and mistakes are possible. Make sure to verify any generated code or suggestions.

Connection changed. Database name: NEDERLANDSEGROOTHANDEL

Status: Ready

Content generated by AI can include mistakes - please review the response.

100%

No issues found

Ln: 1 Ch: 1 TABS CRLF

nes-preview.database... r_eskens@hotmail.com (71) | NEDERLANDSEGROOTHANDEL | 00:00:00 | 0 rows

COPILOT

NOT YOUR OTTO PILOT

It's for everyone



A photograph of a modern, brightly lit escalator with glass railings and illuminated handrails. The escalator steps are a light gray color. The text "Level up" is overlaid in a large, bold, black sans-serif font across the center of the image. The background is a gradient of blue and purple.

Level up

FAIL

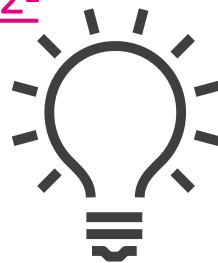
- ▶ Preferably on a Friday
- ▶ At 17:00
- ▶ Lose your weekend

A high-angle, top-down photograph of five business professionals (three men and two women) standing in a circle on a light-colored tiled floor. They are all reaching their hands towards the center, where they are stacked together. The image is overlaid with a blue-to-purple gradient. The word "axians" is in the top right, and "DEMO!" is in the middle left.

axians

DEMO!

- Wait stats (<https://link.springer.com/book/10.1007/978-1-4842-8771-2>)
- Who is active (<http://whoisactive.com/>)
- Disk latency (<https://sqlperformance.com/2015/03/io-subsystem/monitoring-read-write-latency>)





axians



What they should have told me about becoming a DBA

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<https://sqlreitse.com>

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/reitseeskens/>

<https://github.com/reitse/Speaking>

@2meterDBA

Thank
you!

